Why multimedia ethics matters

- A library may own a digital file without owning copyright in the work it contains.
- A record may be authentic but confidential; a technically accessible video can still exclude viewers.
- Responsible publication checks rights, lawful processing, dignity, access and accuracy before release.

TAKEAWAY An available file is not necessarily a publishable file.

Five publication gates

- Confirm purpose and audience, copyright or other permission, privacy or lawful data handling, accessibility, and factual integrity.
- Record the evidence for each gate, including unresolved questions and who can authorise publication.
- If a gate is unresolved, choose restricted review or a redesigned resource rather than guessing.

TAKEAWAY Documented review is a professional workflow.

BLISS and BRIM examples

- BLISS: an online library exhibition combines scanned photographs, narration, credit lines and captions.
- BRIM: an archival portal presents a restricted records series and public descriptions of selected items.
- Both need rights checks; BRIM additionally emphasises record provenance, restrictions and retention responsibilities.

TAKEAWAY One framework applies to different professional situations.

What copyright protects

- Original writing, photographs, music, audiovisual works and some creative designs can receive copyright protection.
- Copyright generally relates to protected expression, not merely the fact or idea conveyed by that expression.
- Digitisation changes the carrier; it does not automatically extinguish or transfer existing rights.

TAKEAWAY **Capture and ownership are not the same legal question.**

Tanzania copyright framework

- Tanzania’s Copyright and Neighbouring Rights Act, Chapter 218, R.E. 2023 is a key national reference.
- Copyright owners may hold rights relevant to copying, adaptation, distribution and public communication.
- Check the applicable law, licence terms, exceptions and institutional guidance before distributing a protected resource.

TAKEAWAY **Do not assume every educational use is automatically permitted.**

Permission and rights evidence

- Record the work, rights holder, source, licence or permission, permitted acts, limitations and review date.
- A photograph can involve distinct interests: photographer copyright, depicted-person privacy and archive ownership of a print.
- A rights clearance record should travel with metadata and authorised access versions.

TAKEAWAY Clearance is item-specific and use-specific.

Creative Commons is a set of licences

- CC BY requires attribution; CC BY-SA additionally imposes a share-alike condition for shared adaptations.
- CC BY-NC restricts commercial use; CC BY-ND restricts sharing adapted versions under that licence.
- CC0 is a distinct public-domain dedication tool, not another six-condition CC licence.

TAKEAWAY **Read the exact licence and its version.**

An effective attribution example

- For a fictitious CC BY 4.0 photograph, state title, creator, source link, licence link and whether it was adapted.
- Example: “Library entrance”, A. Example, CC BY 4.0, cropped from original (fictional exercise).
- Keep a credit record with the project so attribution survives a future site redesign.

TAKEAWAY Credit requires traceable information, not “Source: internet”.

Choosing a reuse approach

- First ask who owns the material and whether it is clearly licensed or in the public domain.
- Then test your intended use: cropping, translation, video remix, commercial publication and distribution may differ.
- Where licensing conditions are uncertain, request permission or choose suitably licensed original material.

TAKEAWAY A licence is permission with conditions, not a blank cheque.

Personal data is not just names

- Identifiable faces, voices, addresses, ID numbers and combinations of contextual clues may reveal personal information.
- An oral-history interview may disclose information about speakers and third parties who never participated.
- Separate the decision to retain an object from the decision to disclose it openly.

TAKEAWAY A public catalogue can expose privacy even without a download.

Tanzanian data protection context

- Tanzania’s Personal Data Protection Act, 2022 and the 2023 collection and processing regulations govern personal-data responsibilities.
- Organisations should identify their lawful basis, purpose, necessity, security and authorised disclosures under applicable requirements.
- Consent is one possible basis in some circumstances, not an automatic substitute for all other obligations.

TAKEAWAY Consult current law and institutional officers for real cases.

Consent quality and withdrawal

- Meaningful consent explains purpose, audience, media formats, online visibility and foreseeable reuse.
- Record who agreed, what was agreed, when and how follow-up or withdrawal requests will be handled where applicable.
- A signed form alone cannot prove that the resulting publication is safe, necessary or within the agreed scope.

TAKEAWAY Consent is a process with evidence, not just a checkbox.

Archives and restrictions

- Retention obligations may justify keeping a record even when public release would be inappropriate.
- Review confidential case files, personnel data and historically sensitive testimony for restrictions before creating access copies.
- Redaction should be deliberate, verified and documented; covering text visually may leave hidden text retrievable.

TAKEAWAY Preserve an authorised original; publish a checked derivative.

Photographs of children

- Children’s images and school records call for elevated safeguarding, carefully reviewed permissions and data minimisation.
- A parent or guardian’s authorisation may be relevant, but local rules and institutional policy must be checked.
- Avoid unnecessary names, locations and identifiers; prefer fictional or non-identifying teaching examples.

TAKEAWAY Protect people before showcasing media.

Sensitive cultural collections

- Culturally significant recordings may require consultation beyond narrow technical ownership questions.
- Respect community expectations, dignity, context, sacred or restricted knowledge and possible downstream harm.
- Involve relevant custodians and document why access was granted, limited or deferred.

TAKEAWAY **Lawful does not always mean respectful or appropriate.**

Inclusive design principles

- Accessibility means people can perceive, operate, understand and access information using varied abilities and technologies.
- Provide semantic headings, descriptive link labels, keyboard operability, visible focus and readable responsive layouts.
- Test the resource with assistive technologies and people, not only automated checkers.

TAKEAWAY **Accessibility starts during planning, not at final export.**

Captions, transcripts and descriptions

- Captions communicate spoken words and important non-speech audio; subtitles may communicate dialogue only.
- A descriptive transcript also records important visual information, while audio description conveys visuals during video playback.
- Accurate timing and speaker identification can be essential for an oral-history or archival interview.

TAKEAWAY **Different alternatives serve different access needs.**

Contrast and text legibility

- For WCAG 2.2 Level AA, normal text generally needs at least 4.5:1 contrast and large text at least 3:1.
- Important graphical objects and interface components may need 3:1 non-text contrast in relevant cases.
- Use real text where practical, scalable layout, sufficient spacing and colour-independent meaning.

TAKEAWAY Colour alone should not communicate a required instruction.

Responsible AI-assisted production

- Generative AI can assist with transcription drafts, descriptions, translation and production planning.
- It can also fabricate scenes, alter historical context, misidentify people or generate fluent but inaccurate metadata.
- A qualified person should review factual claims, provenance and any public representation of history.

TAKEAWAY **Fluent output is not verified evidence.**

Synthetic media disclosure

- Label substantial AI-generated or materially altered images, voices and footage when their origin matters to interpretation.
- Keep source records, editing decisions and approval logs so users can distinguish evidence from interpretation.
- Do not impersonate real interviewees or fabricate archival provenance for a teaching demonstration.

TAKEAWAY Authenticity depends on transparent context.

Privacy when using AI tools

- Never upload restricted institutional scans or identifiable interviews to external AI tools without appropriate authorisation.
- Check vendor data handling, retention, access controls and institutional policy before processing protected information.
- Use synthetic excerpts or locally approved tools for student exercises where possible.

TAKEAWAY A helpful tool does not remove professional obligations.

A difficult publication decision

- A 1970s public event photograph may be valuable for research yet contain identifiable people and uncertain rights.
- The correct next step is a rights and privacy review, not immediate publication or unconditional deletion.
- Possible outcomes include permission requests, restricted access, contextual notice or a safer substitute.

TAKEAWAY Document uncertainties and a proportionate response.

Accessibility is not merely compliance

- An accessible transcript lets researchers search interview content and supports users with low bandwidth.
- Captions improve comprehension of unfamiliar accents and noisy recordings beyond disability access.
- Clear navigation and meaningful labels help every user of a digital collection.

TAKEAWAY Inclusive design can improve core information services.

Avoiding a single-solution rule

- There is no universal “yes” to using an image because it is educational, old, online or attributed.
- An institution must consider purpose, permissions, restriction periods, applicable law and harms together.
- When uncertainty is material, escalate to the responsible academic or institutional officer.

TAKEAWAY Professional judgement requires evidence and accountability.

Rights and consent register

- Record item identifier, creator, rights basis, evidence location, data classification and permitted access mode.
- Add review dates, restrictions, expiry conditions and the person responsible for a decision.
- Record changes so later staff can understand why a media item was or was not released.

TAKEAWAY **Maintain a decision trail alongside the collection.**

Publish an access derivative

- Keep the source protected; create a limited, accessible and correctly credited public version where justified.
- Remove or mask only authorised elements, then verify that hidden layers, transcripts and metadata do not leak information.
- Maintain the source-to-derivative relation and a publication approval record.

TAKEAWAY Redaction must be technically verified.

When a complaint arrives

- Identify the affected item, preserve relevant logs and acknowledge the concern through institutional channels.
- Review rights, consent, privacy and accuracy without altering source evidence silently.
- Document decisions, corrective action and any changes to catalogue records or user-facing media.

TAKEAWAY **Responsive stewardship continues after publication.**

Keyboard and focus test

- A user should navigate interactive elements with keyboard controls without encountering a trap.
- Focus indication must be visible and the tab order should follow meaningful reading order.
- Try the site with the mouse disconnected, then inspect any unreachable action.

TAKEAWAY Accessible interaction must work, not just be described.

Image and media alternatives

- Alt text should communicate an image’s meaningful purpose, not repeat its filename or decorative appearance.
- Decorative images may use empty alternative text; complex exhibits need surrounding explanation.
- For speech-based video, offer synchronised captions and an appropriate transcript or description.

TAKEAWAY Alternatives should preserve equivalent information.

Accessibility evaluation evidence

- Document test date, device, keyboard sequence, zoom level, contrast measurements and identified barriers.
- Record the fix and retest; one automatic checker cannot establish full usability.
- Prioritise barriers that prevent completing an important library or archival task.

TAKEAWAY Testing is iterative and evidence-based.

BLISS: digital exhibition

- A fictional library creates a public cultural-photograph gallery with captions and an audio introduction.
- It requires ownership/permission checks, non-identifying descriptions, alt text, transcript and keyboard navigation.
- A rights register explains which assets may be published and how credits are displayed.

TAKEAWAY An exhibition is a managed publication, not only a design.

BRIM: oral-history archive

- A fictional archive holds interviews with potentially sensitive references to family members and workplaces.
- The source files are protected; selected derivatives require scope-specific permissions, transcripts and access review.
- Publication decisions must preserve provenance, restriction rules and an audit trail.

TAKEAWAY **Retention and public release are different acts.**

A 20-mark professional portfolio

- Build an item register, explain permissions and consent, test accessible alternatives and decide release conditions.
- For each of five fictional items, justify publish, restrict, replace or escalate, without relying on guessed legal exceptions.
- Submit evidence of attribution, privacy controls and one accessibility test.

TAKEAWAY Strong work shows defensible decisions and working examples.

Common misconceptions

- “It is online” does not mean public domain; “I credited it” does not replace a required licence or permission.
- “The person agreed to recording” does not necessarily authorise unlimited online reuse.
- “The AI wrote it” does not establish historical accuracy or allow confidential uploads.

TAKEAWAY Question assumptions before publishing.

A responsible release checklist

- Identify the audience, purpose and object; review rights, privacy, metadata, quality and accessibility.
- Approve only the least-exposing suitable derivative; record a named decision maker and any restrictions.
- Set a review route for correction, complaints or changed permissions.

TAKEAWAY Publication is an accountable process.

Ethical decisions in applied projects

- The final multimedia project combines media production, metadata, accessible interaction and controlled publication.
- Rights, consent, provenance and ethical decisions belong in every project test and evaluation.
- A professional output is useful, evidence-based, inclusive and maintainable.

TAKEAWAY Ethical quality is part of technical quality.